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Placement Director: Jaroslav Borovička jaroslav.borovicka@nyu.edu 347-899-6273
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Education

PhD in Economics, New York University, 2021-2027 (expected)
Fields: Macroeconomics, Housing
MA in Economics, Collegio Carlo Alberto (Allievi Program), 2018-2020
MSc in Economics, University of Turin, 2018-2020
BA in Economics, University of Trento, 2015-2018

References

Professor Corina Boar
New York University
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Professor Raquel Fernández
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Professor Guido Menzio
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Sharon Traiberman
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Teaching Experience

Spring 2025, Fall 2025	Introduction to Econometrics, TA
Fall 2022, Fall 2024	Intermediate Macroeconomics, TA
Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2026, Fall 2026	International Economics, TA

Research Experience and Other Employment

2020-2021	European Central Bank, Trainee, Directorate General Statistics

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships

2021-2027	NYU MacCracken Fellowship
2021	Unicredit Marco Fanno Scholarship
2018-2020	Carlo Alberto Allievi Honors Program
2015-2018	University of Trento Honors Program

Research Papers

Declining Fertility and Housing Costs (Job Market Paper)

I study how the cost of family space shapes fertility and how can housing policy affect it. Housing costs are at the center of the public debate on declining fertility: children need space, and young households, who have little savings, find that space costly to pay for. I build a life-cycle model in which households choose whether to have children, whether and how much to rent or own, and how much to save. Buying requires a down payment, and earnings are risky. I calibrate the model to the United States in 2007 and treat the fall in births since then as an exogenous decline in the taste for children. Along the transition to a new steady state with a smaller population, fewer households make housing cheaper, which feeds back into fertility. Because a child is a long commitment, earnings risk weighs on fertility, and lower risk raises births. I then use the model to assess housing policy. Easier mortgage credit could give young households access to the larger homes a child requires, but it does little for births. Policies that change long-term incentives, such as more housing supply and credit for parents, raise fertility, and their effects build up over a generation. Housing policy must therefore be judged by its long-run effects.

Consumption Sorting and Inequality (with Saverio Spinella)

We study a spatial economy in which heterogeneous households and retailers jointly choose locations and trade in local markets, subject to housing congestion and shopping frictions. Retail competition can reinforce sorting and even sustain complete income segregation when heterogeneity in product tastes outweighs the shopping complementarities between poor and rich households. Two-sided sorting drives the mechanism: richer households locate in higher-amenity locations, and higher quality retailers cluster in those same locations, reinforcing the segregation pattern. Cross-household spillovers in prices paid have been the focus of the demand-driven market power literature; here we show that they are absent when sorting motives are strong enough. Using NielsenIQ data, we find evidence supporting the two-sided sorting mechanism: shopping intensity rises with retailer density and the price premium for high-end goods falls where the average retailer offers more high-end products. A calibrated version of the model allows us to study place-based policies aimed at reducing the cost of living. Budget-balanced subsidies that lower retailers' costs are most effective in poorer locations. The burden of the implied redistribution on rich households can be mitigated by moderate price controls in the locations they cluster in.

Research In Progress

Frictional Rental Markets and Inequality

Using ACS microdata, I document new facts on the heterogeneity of paid rents across individuals and cities. First, young people tend to pay higher rents and move more frequently, especially in denser and less housing-elastic cities. Second, recent movers—both within and across cities—pay systematically higher rents. These effects are heterogeneous across space and stronger in larger, denser metropolitan areas. To rationalize these patterns, I develop a parsimonious model of directed search in the rental market. The model explains the observed dispersion in paid rents and implies that increases in housing supply would disproportionately benefit younger and more mobile households.

Presentations

2026: DC Search & Matching Workshop*; SaM Annual Conference*; Symposium on Real Estate & Urban Policy — Indiana University/Chicago Fed.
NYU Macroeconomics Lunch; NYU Applied Microeconomics Student Lunch; NYU Stern Macro Lunch.
* Coauthor Presentation.